



DC ventures into D&D

DC Comics is creating a 40-page sourcebook which will be published under D&D's Open-Gaming License. <https://digit.in/feb20-25>



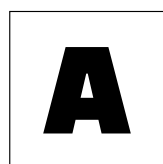
Obi Wan series put on hold

As per reports, the Obi Wan Disney+ series starring Ewan McGregor may have been put on hold indefinitely. <https://digit.in/feb20-26>

Can video games improve brain function?

Your brain is yours... if you don't use it, you lose it!

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According to American Psychiatric Association video games can't cause any kind of addiction. However,

they can cause a different kind of addiction – a behavioural addiction that makes someone to play video games excessively.

Behavioural addiction is a kind of addiction that doesn't involve the use of any drugs but it happens because of a rewarding behaviour. This type of addiction happens because of the rewarding system of our brain. Our brain is functioning because of the neurotransmitters like serotonin, GABA and dopamine. Certain activity or behaviour can increase such neurotransmitter levels in the brain and can give pleasure. That's why this could vary from person to person, because everybody's brain chemistry is not same.

Usually any drug related addiction is cured using de-addiction (substitute) drugs. As the substitute drug is tapered gradually on daily basis, the brain starts to reduce its dependency on the drug. Similarly, for any behavioural addiction, the de-addiction can be done using a substitute game. For example, if a user starts playing a game, he finds some difficulty in the beginning but after winning the first level of the game, his dopamine level increases and so he wants to play for the next level, but as the level goes up, the difficulty level also goes up. This causes the brain to take stress from the game and wants to play again and again to reach the top level.

Therefore, de-addicting from such video games can be possible using a substitute video game. Games like PUBG cause addiction because of their

addictive algorithm and interface, but if a similar video game is created using reverse engineering and then changing the gaming code in a way that it will be less difficult and awarding, then playing that game will make someone to get 'de-addicted' from a similar video game. However, to get rid of video game addiction, the best solution is to play them with breaks instead of hours on end.



PSYCHOLOGICAL EFFECT

Video games are rated by the Entertainment Software Rating Board (ESRB) of USA according to the age group. According to ESRB games which are designed for everyone are rated as 'E', above 10yrs are rated as 'E10+', for teens between 10-17 years of age are rated as 'T', games that are for above 17 years of age are rated 'M' and for 18 years and above games are rated as 'A'. If video games are played by the suitable age group, then it should not cause any negative psychological effects. However, some video games are often played by the unsuitable age groups, and that could cause negative psychological effects.

COULD VIDEO GAMES IMPROVE BRAIN FUNCTION?

Even though video games can cause addiction, playing certain games can help improve the brain's cognitive function. Children who play video games develop better cognitive skills and develop better learning abilities. A new research con-

ducted by researchers at Yale University found that children who play video games are often excel at learning.

Many age related brain disorders like Alzheimer's disease, can progress in people who have minimal cognitive usage. One research shows that people who play puzzles and board games frequently, are less likely to develop Alzheimer's disease. Moreover when you play a game like chess on a PC, you are competing with a computer and a computer is a complete logical machine. The more you play with a computer, the better your brain functions. Apart from Alzheimer's disease, some video games might also cure mental disorders like ADHD and games like Project: Evo and Akili are designed to cure ADHD but are awaiting FDA approval.

Video games are also good stress busters, and a new study of millennial gamers has revealed that video games can help reduce mental stress. Behavioral Science Institute in The Netherlands found that some video games can help reduce mental stress and one survey done by Luke Hales, GM of the Dave TV Channel also concluded the same thing.

THE FUTURE

As technology improves, video games will become more useful, to develop your brain's ability to increase its cognitive ability, think logically and inhibit yourself from the menacing addiction. As wise people say, everything in moderation is good, so playing video games in a responsible manner can ultimately help jog your logical thinking abilities. 

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